31/7/25

Mijbil the Otter

- Gavin Maxwell

I Answer the following Word Meanings:-

a A stone's throw: A very short distance
sentence The café is a stone's throw away.

b Fixation: Obsessive focus or attachment
sentence His fixation on perfection caused stress.

c armour: Protective covering, often metal
sentence Knights wore heavy metal armour.

d Juggle: Toss multiple objects or manage many tasks.
sentence She juggled work and parenting daily.

e craning: Stretching neck or body to see
sentence He was craning to see the parade.

II Reference to Context:-

1 "Mijbil ---------- as possible."

a How did the Otter behave for the first 24 hours?
Ans For the first 24 hours, Mijbil was timid and withdrawn, shivering under the divan, reluctant to eat, yet gradually exploring his new surroundings with cautious curiosity.

Q2 Why is the Otter called Maxwell's Otter?
Ans The Otter is called Maxwell's Otter because Gavin Maxwell adopted and raised Mijbil, the Otter became known as Maxwell's Otter, highlighting their unique bond and Maxwell's role as its caretaker.

Q3 Find a word from the extract which means 'having no particular interest'.
Ans Indifferent.

III Answer the following Short Answers:-

Q1 Why did Mr. Maxwell put Mijbil in the box? What did Mijbil do?
Ans He boxed him to protect himself and contain Mijbil during the river crossing. Mijbil chewed, scratched, and shook the box violently, refusing confinement.

Q2 What were the guesses made by Londoners about Mijbil?
ans Londoner's guesses included a seal, a water-rat, a strange cat, a rabbit, a polecat (ferret), a muskrat, a sea-mammal, even a baby porpoise.

Q3 What were the compulsive habits developed by Mijbil?
ans Mijbil obsessively chased and retrieved stones in his tank, insisted on tossing ice lumps into the water,

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gnawed furniture and wires, scratched wooden floors, and snapped hungrily at passing feet.

Q4 What happens when Maxwell took Mijbil to the bathroom? what does it tell about Mijbil?

ans When Maxwell took Mijbil into the bathroom, the otter seized a small pebble, hurled it into the sink's basin and immediately plunged in to retrieve it, then repeated this over and over. This behaviour shows Mijbil's obsessive fixation on chasing and recovering objects - an expression of his innate aquatic play drive and compulsive ritual.

IV Answer the following Long Answers:-

Q1 How did the Otter behave in the beggining? How did he became familiar with the author?

Ans At first Mijbil was shy and fearful, crouching in the corner of his tank with wide, unblinking eyes. He refused to eat, trembled at unfamiliar sounds, and recoiled from any human approach, making even simple handling a daunting task.

Maxwell won Mijbil's trust through gentle persistence. He offered small fish by hand, spoke softly, and learned the otter's rhythms. Gradually, Mijbil grew less apprehensive, accepting food from Maxwell and allowing light touches without flinching.

As days passed, Mijbil began recognizing Maxwell's voice and footsteps. He started following Maxwell around the room, playfully splashed when they visited the bathroom, and sought out the author's presence, transforming from timid captive to affectionate companion.

Note 6/8/25